

FUNDAMENTALS

Basic Crochet Stitches for Beginners: Complete Guide

Six stitches, in the order you'll actually need them, each explained step by step.

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Nearly every crochet pattern on this site, from our [dishcloth pattern](#) to our [granny square blanket](#), is built from some combination of the six stitches below. Learn them roughly in this order, and you'll have everything you need for the vast majority of beginner patterns.

The six basic stitches

01

Chain stitch

Abbreviation: ch

The foundation of almost every project. Yarn over the hook and pull it through the loop already on your hook. Repeat to build a chain of any length — this is usually the very first row you make.

02

Slip stitch

Abbreviation: sl st

Insert your hook into a stitch, yarn over, and pull the yarn through both the stitch and the loop on your hook in one motion. Slip stitches don't add height — they're mainly used to join rounds or move across a row without building fabric.

 Crochet hook with yarn showing stitch formation

03

Single crochet

Abbreviation: sc

Insert your hook into a stitch, yarn over and pull up a loop (two loops now on your hook), yarn over again and pull through both loops. This is the shortest, densest stitch, and the one used throughout our [dishcloth pattern](#).

04

Half double crochet

Abbreviation: hdc

Yarn over before inserting your hook into the stitch. Insert, yarn over and pull up a loop (three loops on your hook), yarn over once more and pull through all three loops at once. Slightly taller and softer than single crochet.

05

Double crochet

Abbreviation: dc

Yarn over before inserting your hook. Insert, yarn over and pull up a loop (three loops on hook), yarn over and pull through just two loops (two loops remain), yarn over again and pull through the final two loops. Taller still, with more drape.

06

Treble (triple) crochet

Abbreviation: tr

Yarn over twice before inserting your hook. Insert, yarn over and pull up a loop (four loops on hook), then yarn over and pull through two loops, three separate times, until one loop remains. The tallest of the six, used less often in beginner patterns.

Quick comparison

STITCH	ABBR.	YARN OVERS BEFORE INSERTING	RELATIVE HEIGHT
Chain	ch	—	—
Slip stitch	sl st	0	None

Single crochet	sc	0	Shortest
Half double crochet	hdc	1	Short-medium
Double crochet	dc	1	Medium-tall
Treble crochet	tr	2	Tallest

Frequently asked questions

What is the easiest crochet stitch to learn first?

Chain stitch is the very first stitch every crocheter learns, followed by single crochet. Together these two stitches are enough to complete an entire beginner project, like our dishcloth pattern.

What is the difference between single, half double, and double crochet?

The difference is height and the number of yarn overs used before completing the stitch. Single crochet is shortest and densest, half double crochet is a middle height, and double crochet is taller and drapes more loosely.

Do I need to learn treble crochet as a beginner?

Not right away. Treble crochet appears less often in beginner patterns than the shorter stitches, so it's fine to learn it later once single, half double, and double crochet feel comfortable.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.